- Hospitals provide the patient with the right to not only accept their visitors, but also to deny them. It doesn't help a patient's recovery if the visitor is someone who will only bring them added stress.
- Visitors are allowed to stay as long as they want, even overnight.
- Provide wireless access along with the usual TV's and comfortable chairs.
- Counselling services and places to pray and meditate.
- Make waiting time more productive—or at least less boring.
- Help people connect more easily with hospital billing, physicians, scheduling, etc.
- Learn more about your patients and visitors—and about their hospital experiences

3.7 Discharging the Patient

Discharge is a preparation of a patient and discharge records to leave the hospital.

Purpose

1. To ensure continuity of care to the patient after discharge.
2. To assist the patient in discharge process.

Guidelines

The patient are discharged from the hospital in one of the following ways.

1. **Discharge to home.** The discharge to home or another hospital or another unit within the hospital is initiated by the doctor who advises the patient that he is well enough to leave the hospital or requires treatment in another unit within the hospital or in an another hospital.
2. **Discharge to another hospital or another unit within the hospital (referral).** When a patient or family is not satisfied with the treatment or care given and wants to leave the hospital against the medical advice, in such cases the patient of the relative is asked to sign a statement that he is going or taking the patient on his own will and responsibility.
3. **Discharge against medical advice (AMA).** Patient leaves the hospital against the medical officer's advice when a patient escapes from the hospital without the knowledge of the hospital staff and without signing the said statement he is treated as absconded in the records.

3.7.1 Nurses Responsibility

1. Inform the patient and the relatives a day or two before the discharge.
2. Get the discharge slip prepared after checking the vital signs and examining the patient.
3. The nurses should see that the patients personnel hygiene is maintained, he is dressed in home clothes and has taken meals.
4. Hand over the patient's belongings and any valuables, which have been kept safely, to the patient or the relative under proper receipt.
5. Complete the unit admission and discharge registers, case sheet and other records.

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